Required Affinity Home Group Exercises for White Participants

Format and Process

Brief check-in, 5-minute meditation at beginning of each session; brief checkout at the end.

Please rotate the facilitation role among the group members, with a different person facilitating each meeting. The facilitator will keep time, ring the bell at the beginning and end of the meditation, and guide the group to follow the agenda. The meeting timeline should be held flexibly; if the group needs more time for a particular item, the time frames can be adjusted by agreement of the group.

Each group member is encouraged to help monitor process by speaking up skillfully if the group is drifting off point and/or by offering gentle reminders of the ***Agreements for Multicultural Interactions***.

One of the best ways to ensure real inclusivity is by practicing mindful listening, avoiding cross-talk, and methodically going around the circle in response to a question or discussion topic. This practice systematically invites all voices. Anyone who feels like speaking first starts the circle for a question or activity. This way, the same person isn't starting every time. When the first person is finished sharing, they call on the next person, and so forth, until everyone has spoken. **It's OK to pass** on any given round. Use the **Right to Pass** agreement sparingly and take time to reflect if you are passing more than once in a meeting.

Session 1

00 Introductions: Share your name, pronouns, geographic location, and a “fun fact” about yourself.

10 Mindfulness meditation

15 Read the ***Agreements for Multicultural Interactions*** aloud as a group. Go around the circle with each person reading one. Go around again with each person sharing:

- One agreement that comes easily for you
- One agreement that is challenging, that you want to work on

25 Personal stories of race. Go around the circle with each person sharing; please divide the time equally among participants.

- What were you taught about race as a child?
- What was one of the first times you remember being aware of race? Briefly describe the context, the content, and the emotions/thoughts you had.

45 Reflections on today’s conversation. Go around the circle with each person sharing what stood out for you in today’s sharing/listening. Please divide the time equally among participants. Stay rooted in the agreements of **Practice Self-Focus** and **Try It On**.

55 One-sentence checkout. Go around the circle with each person offering one or two sentences about how the conversation today was for them.

Session 2

00 Check-ins: Two or three sentences about the energy you are bringing to the group today, and one thing that stays with you from the Session 2 video.

05 Mindfulness meditation practicing the first three warm-up steps in Insight Dialogue:

- **Pause**: When you notice your mind has wandered, you call your awareness into the present moment with "pause."
- **Relax**: Invite your body to relax. Belly soft, breath deepens. Bring kind acceptance to whatever sensations, thoughts, or feelings are present.
- **Open**: Expand your attention outward, extending your awareness beyond your body and mind.

10 Review the ***Agreements for Multicultural Interactions*** by going around the circle with each person reading one agreement.

15 What experience arose for you as you watched the video, witnessing the reality of structural oppression?

30 Please share your answers to the following questions:

- How has the history of redlining/housing segregation benefited you and/or your family? (e.g., if your family owned a house, accumulated wealth; living environment; tax base for schools, parks, playgrounds; whether or not you grew up in a diverse community)
- What might be different for you if this practice and all its many ramifications were made clear to you all along?

Go around the circle with each person sharing; please divide the time equally among participants.

55 One-sentence checkout. Go around the circle with each person offering one or two sentences about how the conversation today was for you. Stay rooted in the agreement of **Practice Self-Focus**.

Session 3

00 Check-ins: Two or three sentences about the energy you are bringing to the group today, and one thing that stays with you from the Session 3 video.

05 Metta meditation

10 Review the ***Agreements for Multicultural Interactions*** by going around the circle with each person reading one agreement.

15 “I was not a hero” stories. Please share a brief story of a time when you said or did (or didn’t say or didn’t do) something in a racially charged situation that you regret. Please talk about how this affected you and what you might do differently if you could do it over again. If you can, identify the way(s) that you were defending the “good white self.” Please divide the time evenly among participants. Stay rooted in the agreement of **No Blaming or Shaming Self & Others**, without cross-talk.

35 Please share your journaled responses to the “opening to suffering” video, including body sensations, feeling tone, perceptions, thoughts/emotions/impulses/ideas. What practices help you stay present with suffering? Please divide the time evenly among participants. Stay rooted in the agreement of **Practice Mindful Listening** without cross-talk.

50 Checkout: Each person shares what stood out for them in this conversation.

Session 4

00 Check-ins: Two or three sentences about the energy you are bringing to the group today, and one thing that stays with you from the Session 4 video.

10 Guided RAIN meditation: What arises when we are “called out” on race-related issues? Consider turning off your video during the guided RAIN practice. Please divide the time evenly among participants. Stay rooted in the agreements of **Practice Mindful Listening** without cross-talk and **No Blaming or Shaming Self & Others**.

20 Each group member describes their experience with the guided RAIN meditation: What arose as you recalled/imagined being called out, as well as any experiences arising from investigating and nurturing?

35 Each group member briefly describes a situation in which they were “called out.” (Perhaps the “I was not a hero” story. If you can’t think of a time you were called out, maybe you witnessed an interaction or you could use one of the examples from the microaggressions talk or video.) Explain what happened in no more than 3 sentences.

If you have time, try both of the apologies in present tense, as if you were talking to the person who did the calling out.

> Version 1: What you might say if you were flooded or just not able to process in the moment what just happened.
>
> Version 2: A full apology, as outlined in Session 4.

After each version, group members give specific feedback about what worked well.

55 One-sentence checkout. Go around the circle with each person offering one or two sentences about how the conversation today was for them.

Session 5

00 Check-ins: Two or three sentences about the energy you are bringing to the group today, and one thing that stays with you from the Session 5 video.

10 Pause-Relax-Open meditation

15 Review the ***Agreements for Multicultural Interactions*** by going around the circle with everyone taking turns reading an agreement.

20 Role-Plays: Calling in another white person. (See Embodied Learning Affinity Homegroup 5 for role-plays.) Try to make sure everyone doesn't practice with the same scenario. Also, be sure that everyone gets a chance to try role-playing "calling in" another white person.

55 One-sentence checkout. Go around the circle with each person offering one or two sentences about how the conversation today was for them.

Session 6

Required Affinity Home Group Assignment

- Before the Required Affinity Home Group meeting, please complete this written assignment (maximum 2 pages):
    - Describe the learning culture you want to create in your classroom/group
    - Write an inclusive description/invitation to a mindfulness course you wish to offer
    - Identify 5 inclusion practices that you will use
- How will you continue your learning in this area?
- How will you hold yourself accountable?

00 Check-ins: Two or three sentences about the energy you are bringing to the group today, and one thing that stays with you from the Session 6 video.

05 Pause-Relax-Open meditation

10 Review the Agreements for Multicultural Interactions by going around the circle with each person reading one agreement.

15 Each person briefly shares their inclusive course plan.

40 Each person briefly shares how they will continue learning in this area, and how they will hold themselves accountable.

50 Checkout:

- What are you taking away from these sessions?
- What is (at least) one thing you are proud of about how you engaged with this material?